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STEVEN LAUTERWASSER

appointment

Senior Research Scientist, A Healthier Democracy, 2024-
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Burnes Center for Social Change, Northeastern University, 2024-
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Sociology, Northeastern University, 2022-2024.

education

Ph.D. in Sociology, University of California, Berkeley, 2022.
Dissertation: *Sound and Fury, Signifying Something: Polarization, Identity, and Dissatisfaction*
Committee: Kim Voss (chair), Ann Swidler, Paul Pierson
M.A. in Sociology, University of California, Berkeley, 2017.
B.A. in History with Honors, University of Chicago, 2012.

publications

Steven Lauterwasser, Laura K. Nelson, Jessica R. Gold, Alexander J. Gates, Kathrin Zippel. 2026.
“What Gets Lost in Translation? Epistemic Tensions Between Translation and Diffusion in
Practice-Oriented Scholarship.” *Gender & Society* 40(4). [\[link\]](#)
Reese J.F. Green, Timothy Scheinert, Sudharshan Krishnamurthy, Nicole Nyamongo, **Steven
Lauterwasser**, Alister Martin. 2025. “Removing Barriers to Government Benefits: Link
Health’s Role in Advancing Health Equity Through Expanded Enrollment.” *ConductScience
Journal* 1(2).
Julissa Barrios, Timothy Scheinert, Jessica Johnson, Austin Tsai, **Steven Lauterwasser**, Alister
Martin. 2025. “Money as Medicine: Beyond the Monetary Value of Cash Assistance
Programs.” *ConductScience Journal* 1(1).
Abhi Jain, Timothy Scheinert, Sammer Marzouk, Alessandro Hammond, **Steven Lauterwasser**,
Alister Martin. . “Leveraging Text-Based Outreach to Improve Enrollment in Federal
Benefit Programs and Address Broadband Internet Access.” *ConductScience Journal* 1(1).
Kim Voss, **Steven Lauterwasser**, Irene Bloemraad. 2024. “Inactive and quiescent? Immigrant
Collective Action in Comparative Perspective, 1960-1995.” *Socius* 10. [\[link\]](#)
Shared primary authorship, names are listed in reverse alphabetical order.
Steven Lauterwasser and Nataliya Nedzhvetskaya. 2023. “Privacy in Public? The Ethics of
Academic Research with Publicly Available Social Media Data.” *Berkeley Journal of Sociology*
64: 126-146. [\[link\]](#)

working papers

Steven Lauterwasser, Kim Voss, Irene Bloemraad. “What Makes a Movement? Domains of
Contention and the Pre-History of the Pro-Immigrant Social Movement, 1960-1995.”
Revise and resubmit.
Steven Lauterwasser, Laura K. Nelson, Jessica R. Gold, Kathrin Zippel. “Talents for the Talented:
Disrupting the Matthew Effect in an NSF Award Program.”
Steven Lauterwasser. “Beyond the Structure of Attitudes: Belief Systems, Affect, and Polarization.”
Jennifer Dudley and Steven Lauterwasser. “Polar Opposites: Real and Imagined Differences in
Partisan Candidate Evaluation.”

Steven Lauterwasser. "Strangers in their Own Party: Dissatisfied Partisans and the Worldview Model of Polarization."

Steven Lauterwasser. "Negative Partisanship is Not Enough: Affective Polarization, Asymmetry, and a Failed Theory Contest."

**grants,
fellowships,
and awards**

Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor, UC Berkeley. 2021.

Research Fellow, Solidarity and Strife: Democracies in a Time of Pandemic. 2020-2021.

Certificate of Teaching and Learning in Higher Education, UC Berkeley. 2020.

Graduate Division Summer Grant, UC Berkeley. 2018, 2019, 2020.

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley. 2018.

Leo Lowenthal Dissertation Fellowship, UC Berkeley. 2018.

Department of Sociology Small Research Grant, UC Berkeley. 2017.

Summer Research Funding, UC Berkeley. 2014, 2015.

Foreign Language Acquisition Grant, UChicago. 2011.

Rockefeller Choral Scholar, UChicago. 2011-2012.

presentations

"Increasing Voter Participation Through Health Care-Based Voter Registration." Analyst Institute. Virtual. 2024.

Invited panelist.

"Reading Between the Lines: Institutional Constraints and the Production of Knowledge About Gender Equity in NSF ADVANCE." International Conference on Computational Social Science. Philadelphia. 2024.

"What Makes a Movement? Domains of Contention and the prehistory of the Pro-Immigrant Social Movement, 1960-1995." Mobilization Conference. San Diego. 2024.

Co-Authored work with Irene Bloemraad and Kim Voss.

"Beyond the Structure of Attitudes: Belief Systems, Affect, and Polarization." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Philadelphia. 2023.

"Polar Opposites: Real and Imagined Differences in Partisan Candidate Evaluation." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Philadelphia. 2023.

Co-Authored and presented with Jennifer Dudley.

"Mapping interdisciplinary knowledge production from the NSF ADVANCE program." National Science Foundation invited lecture. Virtual. 2023.

Co-Authored and presented with Alexander J. Gates, Laura K. Nelson, Jessica Gold, and Kathrin Zippel.

"Negative Partisanship is Not Enough: Affective Polarization, Asymmetry, and a Failed Theory Contest." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Los Angeles. 2022.

"Asymmetric Identities: Identity-Driven Polarization and Evaluative Schemas." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Virtual. 2021.

“Who Cares What’s Happening in the Streets? Social Movements and Public Opinion Change.”
Social Sciences History Association Annual Conference. Washington, D.C. 2020.

Canceled due to COVID-19.

“From Voldemort to House Elves: Exploring Power in the Wizarding World.” Summer with Harry
Potter and the Sacred Text. Virtual. 2020.

Invited lecture.

“Contentious Contention: The Connection Between Mass Movements and Mass Polarization.”
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. San Francisco, CA. 2020.

Canceled due to COVID-19.

“Contentious Contention: The Connection Between Mass Movements and Mass Polarization.”
Pacific Sociological Association Annual Conference. Eugene, OR. 2020.

Canceled due to COVID-19.

“Only So Much Contention to Go Around: Mass Polarization and Declining Contentious
Collective Action.” Pacific Sociological Association Annual Conference. Oakland, CA. 2019.

“Speaking Sociology: The Problem of Polysemy and the Solution of Metaphor.” Pacific Sociological
Association Annual Conference. Oakland, CA. 2019.

“How Can We Talk to Each Other? Metaphor as a Solution.” American Sociological Association
Annual Meeting. Montreal, QC. 2017.

teaching

“Polarization in Context.” Instructor. Fall 2021.

“Theory Writing Initiative, w/ Theory I.” Writing Instructor. Christopher Muller. Spring 2021.

“Theory Writing Initiative, w/ Theory II.” Writing Instructor. Christopher Muller. Fall 2020.

“Sociological Theory I.” Graduate Student Instructor. Dylan Riley. Spring 2020.

“Evaluation of Evidence.” Graduate Student Instructor. Heather Haveman. Spring 2019.

“Evaluation of Evidence.” Graduate Student Instructor. David Harding. Fall 2017.

“Sociological Theory II.” Graduate Student Instructor. Cihan Tuğal. Spring 2017.

“Sociological Theory I.” Graduate Student Instructor. Dylan Riley. Fall 2016.

“Urban Sociology.” Graduate Student Instructor. Joanna Reed. Spring 2016.

“Sexual Cultures.” Graduate Student Instructor. Jill Bakehorn. Fall 2015.

“Introduction to Sociology.” Graduate Student Instructor. Tom Gold. Spring 2015.

“Evaluation of Evidence.” Graduate Student Instructor. Sam Lucas. Fall 2014.

professional experience

Graduate Student Researcher. Immigration and Social Movements, for Kim Voss and Irene
Bloemraad. 2019-2022.

Member. Mathematical and Experimental Sociology Workshop. 2017-2019.

Writing Tutor. 2016-2017.

Writer. Crash Course Sociology (Online Educational Video). 2016-2017.

Reviewer. Berkeley Journal of Sociology. ad hoc.
Founding Member. Methods and Epistemology in the Social Sciences Workshop. 2015-2017.
Founding Member. Workshop on the State. 2014-2016.
Translator and Research Assistant. Susan Burns, University of Chicago. 2012.

skills *Language*

German (B2/C1 in the Common European Framework)

Technical

Programming (Python, R), machine learning (Keras, PyTorch, Tensorflow, spaCy), statistical modeling (GLMs, multilevel models), data (surveys, data quality, geospatial, text, & network analysis)

Other

Choral Conductor, Music Director, Singer, Pianist